Pork fat cilantro rice

Short-grain rice stirred with a tomatillo, herb and lime purée and carnitas fat

Serves 8 · **Prep** 20 min · **Cook** 30 min · Adapted from masterclass.com

Roy Choi's rice for the oven carnitas: plain rice turned rich with the pork's rendered fat and bright with a quick tomatillo-cilantro purée. Blanch the tomatillos only until they change colour, so the purée stays fresh and green.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (3 cups) short-grain white rice
- 250 ml (1 cup) rendered pork fat, from the carnitas pot, plus more to taste

For the cilantro sauce

- Ice water, for blanching
- 6 medium tomatillos, about 170 g (6 oz), husked and rinsed
- 1 garlic clove, peeled
- Juice of 3 limes, about 80 ml (⅓ cup)
- 1 bunch cilantro, a few sprigs kept back for garnish
- 1 bunch flat-leaf parsley, a few sprigs kept back for garnish
- 125 ml (½ cup) cold water, plus more as needed
- Kosher salt or coarse sea salt, to taste
- Freshly ground black pepper, to taste

METHOD

1. **Rinse and cook the rice.** Put the rice in a pot or bowl (the rice cooker bowl, if you have one) and rinse it under cold water, swirling the grains with your fingers and pouring off the starchy water. Repeat about 5 times, until the water runs nearly clear, then drain. Cook it in a rice cooker or pot following the packet instructions.
2. **Blanch the tomatillos.** Fill a medium bowl with ice water. Bring a medium pot half full of water to the boil over high heat, add the tomatillos and garlic, and cook just until they start to soften and change colour, 1–2 minutes. Lift them into the ice water to stop the cooking.
3. **Blend the sauce.** Put the cooled tomatillos and garlic, the lime juice, a few big pinches of salt and pepper, most of the cilantro and parsley and the cold water in a clean blender. Blend until smooth, about 20 seconds, adding more water if it is too thick. Taste and season, then chill it until the pork is done.
4. **Dress the rice.** When the carnitas come out of the oven, tip the cooked rice (about 6 cups) into a large bowl. Add 125 ml (½ cup) of the chilled sauce and the rendered pork fat and stir well. Taste and season with salt and pepper.
5. **Finish.** Roughly chop the reserved cilantro and parsley sprigs for the garnish, and keep the rest of the sauce to spoon around the plate (see oven carnitas).

NOTES

- The rice needs the fat from the carnitas pot; without carnitas, use lard or the fat from another pork roast.